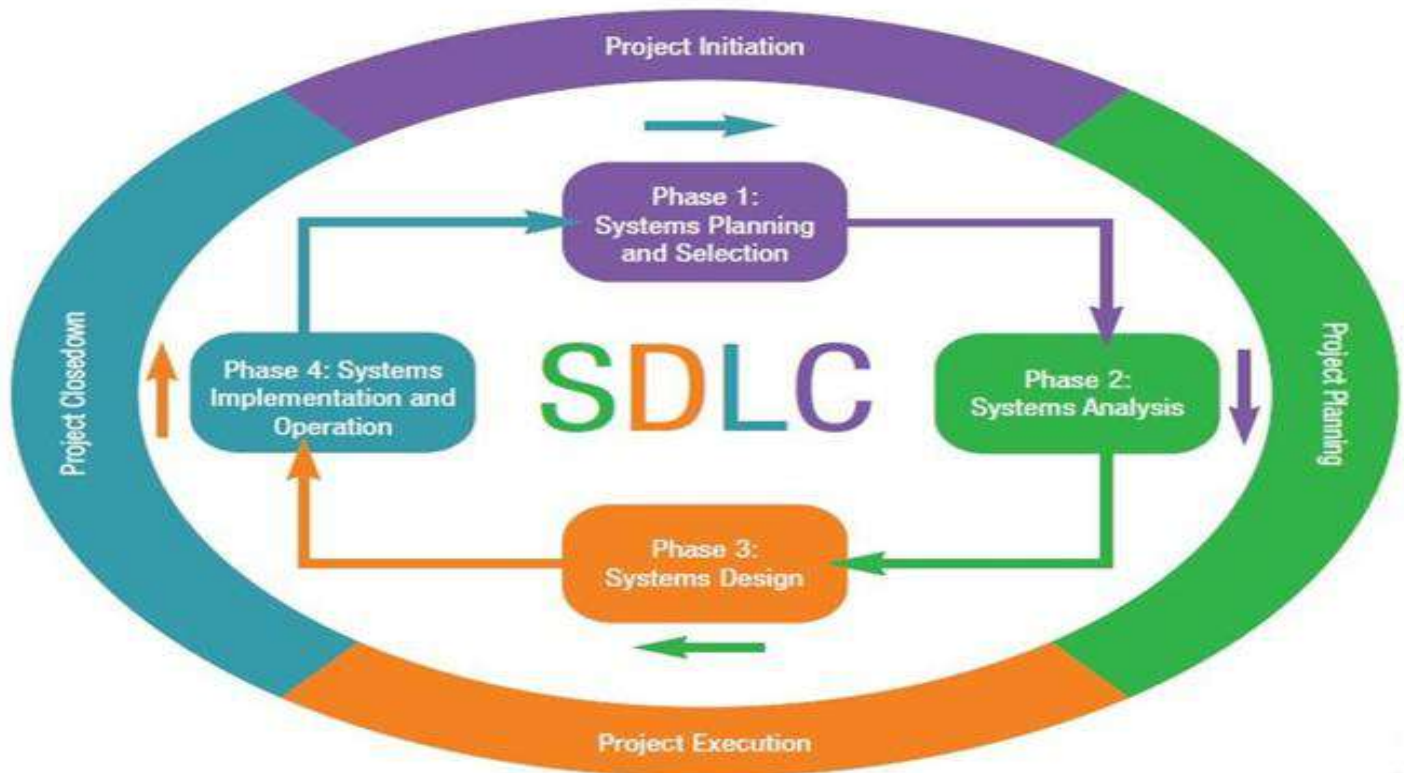


Managing the Information Systems Project

Objectives

- Describe the skills required to be an effective project manager.
- List the skills of a project manager during project initiation, planning, execution, and closedown.
- Explain what is meant by critical path and the process of creating Gantt charts and network diagrams.
- Explain how project management software can be used to in managing project schedules.

The Analyst as a Project Manager throughout the SDLC



Managing the IS Project

- **Project management** is important for the development of information system.
- It is a critical skill for a systems analyst.
- **The focus of project management** is to ensure that:
 1. System development projects meet customer expectations.
 2. Systems are delivered within budget and time constraints.
- **Project** Is a planned undertaking of related activities, having a start and an end, to reach an objective.
- **Project manager** Is a systems analyst with a diverse set of skills management, leadership, technical, conflict management, and customer relationship. He is also responsible for initiating, planning, executing, and closing down a project.
- **Deliverable** The final product in each **phase** of the SDLC.
- **A feasibility study** conducted by the project manager, it is a critical step in determining whether the project is viable, both **technically** and **economically**. It involves evaluating various aspects of the project to ensure that it can be **successfully completed** within the given constraints.
- The study takes place before the system is constructed.

Feasibility Study

• Technical Feasibility

- Technology: Evaluate the technologies required for the project (e.g., programming languages, frameworks, databases).

- Integration: Assess the feasibility of integrating with existing systems or third-party services.

- Scalability: Determine if the system can scale to meet future demands.
- Security: Evaluate the security measures needed to protect data and ensure compliance with regulations.

- Development Team: Assess the availability and expertise of the development team.

• Economic Feasibility

- Cost Estimation: Estimate the total cost of the project, including development, testing, deployment, and maintenance.

- Budget: Compare the estimated costs with the available budget.

- Return on Investment (ROI): Analyze the potential financial benefits and ROI.

- Funding Sources: Identify potential funding sources if additional capital is required.

• Operational Feasibility

- User Requirements: Assess the needs and expectations of the end-users.

- User Training: Determine the training requirements for users and administrators.

- Operational Impact: Evaluate the impact on current operations and workflows.

- Support and Maintenance: Plan for ongoing support and maintenance post-deployment.

System service request (SSR)

- Is a standard form used for requesting systems development work.

- The form includes:

1. The **name** and contact information of the **person** requesting the system.

2. a statement of the **problem**, and the name and contact information of the liaison and sponsor.

System service request for purchasing fulfilment

Pine Valley Furniture System Service Request					
REQUESTED BY	Juanita Lopez		DATE	November 2, 2015	
DEPARTMENT	Purchasing, Manufacturing Support				
LOCATION	Headquarters, I-322				
CONTACT	Tel: 4-3267 FAX: 4-3270 e-mail: jlopez@pvf.com				
TYPE OF REQUEST		URGENCY			
☒	☐	New System	☐	☐	Immediate—Operations are impaired or opportunity lost
☐	☐	System Enhancement	☐	☐	Problems exist, but can be worked around
☐	☐	System Error Correction	☐	☒	Business losses can be tolerated until new system installed
PROBLEM STATEMENT					
Sales growth at PVF has caused greater volume of work for the manufacturing support unit within Purchasing. Further, more concentration on customer service has reduced manufacturing lead times, which puts more pressure on purchasing activities. In addition, cost-cutting measures force Purchasing to be more aggressive in negotiating terms with vendors, improving delivery times, and lowering our investments in inventory. The current modest systems support for manufacturing purchasing is not responsive to these new business conditions. Data are not available, information cannot be summarized, supplier orders cannot be adequately tracked, and commodity buying is not well supported. PVF is spending too much on raw materials and not being responsive to manufacturing needs.					
SERVICE REQUEST					
I request a thorough analysis of our current operations with the intent to design and build a completely new information system. This system should handle all purchasing transactions, support display and reporting of critical purchasing data, and assist purchasing agents in commodity buying.					
IS LIAISON	Chris Martin (Tel: 4-6204 FAX: 4-6200 e-mail: cmartin@pvf.com)				
SPONSOR	Sal Divario, Director, Purchasing				

TO BE COMPLETED BY SYSTEMS PRIORITY BOARD					
☐	☐	Request approved	Assigned to _____		
☐	☐	Recommend revision	Start date _____		
☐	☐	Suggest user development			
☐	☐	Reject for reason			

Project Management Process

- Is a controlled process of initiating, planning, executing, and closing down a project.
- The **project management process**, involves four phases:
- 1. Initiating the project
- 2. Planning the project
- 3. Executing the project
- 4. Closing down the project



Common Activities and Skills of a Project Manager

Activity	Description	Skill
Leadership	Influencing the activities of others toward the attainment of a common goal through the use of intelligence, personality, and abilities	Communication; liaison between management, users, and developers; assigning activities; monitoring progress
Management	Getting projects completed through the effective utilization of resources	Defining and sequencing activities; communicating expectations; assigning resources to activities; monitoring outcomes
Customer relations	Working closely with customers to ensure project deliverables meet expectations	Interpreting system requests and specifications; site preparation and user training; contact point for customers
Technical problem solving	Designing and sequencing activities to attain project goals	Interpreting system requests and specifications; defining activities and their sequence; making trade-offs between alternative solutions; designing solutions to problems
Conflict management	Managing conflict within a project team to ensure that conflict is not too high or too low	Problem solving; smoothing out personality differences; compromising; goal setting
Team management	Managing the project team for effective team performance	Communication within and between teams; peer evaluations; conflict resolution; team building; self-management
Risk and change management	Identifying, assessing, and managing the risks and day-to-day changes that occur during a project	Environmental scanning; risk and opportunity identification and assessment; forecasting; resource redeployment

Initiating the Project

- The first phase of the project management process in which activities are performed to **assess the size, scope, and complexity of the project and to establish procedures to support later project activities.**
- This phase involves defining the project at a high level and obtaining approval to proceed.

Project Initiation

1. Establishing the Project Initiation Team
2. Establishing a Relationship with the Customer
3. Establishing the Project Initiation Plan
4. Establishing Management Procedures
5. Establishing the Project Management Environment and Project Workbook
6. Developing the Project Charter

- **Establishing the project initiation team.** This activity involves organizing an initial core of project team members to assist in accomplishing the project initiation activities.
- **Establishing a relationship with the customer.** A thorough understanding of your customer builds stronger partnerships and higher levels of trust.
- **Establishing the project initiation plan.** This step defines the **activities** required to organize the initiation team while it is working to define the **scope** of the project.
- **Establishing management procedures.** Successful projects require the development of effective management **procedures/approvals**.
- **Developing the project charter.** The **project charter is a short (typically one-page), high-level document prepared for the customer that describes what the project will deliver and outlines many of the key elements of the project.**
- **Establishing the project management environment and project workbook.** The focus of this activity is to collect and organize **the tools** that you **will use** while **managing** the project and to construct the **project workbook**.

Project charter

- It is a formal document that authorizes the existence of a project and provides the project manager with the authority to allocate resources and execute the project. Is a short, high-level document prepared for both internal and external stakeholders and briefly describe its objective, key assumptions, and stakeholders. **It contains:**
- Project title and date of authorization.
- Project manager name and contact information.
- Customer name and contact information.
- Project start and completion dates.
- Project description and objectives.
- Key assumptions or approach.
- Key stakeholders, roles, responsibilities.

Project Charter use case

- Developing a Customer Relationship Management (**CRM**) System: A mid-sized company wants to improve its customer management processes by implementing a new CRM system.
- **Project Title:** CRM System Implementation Project
- **Project Purpose:** The current customer management process is inefficient, leading to missed sales opportunities and poor customer satisfaction. A new CRM system will streamline customer interactions, improve data management, and enhance sales team productivity.
- **Project Objectives:**
 - Implement a CRM system within 6 months.
 - Improve customer data accuracy by 30%.
 - Increase sales team productivity by 20%.
- **Key Stakeholders:** Sales Team, IT Department, Customer Support Team, Finance Department.
- **Constraints:**
 - The project must be completed within the allocated budget of \$150,000.
- **Risks:**
 - Delays in software selection could impact the timeline.
 - Resistance to change from users.

Project charter

Pine Valley Furniture		Prepared: November 2, 2015	
Project Charter			
Project Name:	Customer Tracking System		
Project Manager:	Jim Woo (jwoo@pvf.com)		
Customer:	Marketing		
Project Sponsor:	Jackie Judson (jjudson@pvf.com)		
Project Start/End (projected) dates to:	10/2/15—2/1/15		
Project Overview:			
This project will implement a customer tracking system for the marketing department. The purpose of this system is to automate the . . . to save employee time, reduce errors, have more timely information . . .			
Objectives:			
• Minimize data entry errors • Provide more timely information • . . .			
Key Assumptions:			
• System will be built in-house • Interface will be a Web-browser • System will access customer database • . . .			
Stakeholders and Responsibilities			
Stakeholder	Role	Responsibility	Signatures
Jackie Judson	VP Marketing	Project Vision, Resources	Jackie Judson
Alex Datta	CIO	Monitoring, Resources	Alex Datta
Jim Woo	Project Manager	Plan, Monitor, Execute Project	Jim Woo
James Jordan	Director of Sales	System Functionality	James Jordan
Mary Shide	VP Human Resources	Staff Assignments	Mary Shide

Project workbook

- Is an online or hard-copy **repository**, for all project correspondence, inputs, outputs, deliverables, procedures, and standards, that is used for performing project audits, orienting new team members, communicating with management and customers, identifying future projects, and performing post-project reviews.
- The project workbook can be stored as a **collection of online documents** using Google Docs, Dropbox, Sharepoint, an intranet website, or some other shared and secure online document repository.